

英検準1級 リーディング問題

2024年度 第3回

氏名 _____ 実施日 _____



解答方法 各問について、最も適切なものを1つ選び、問題冊子の選択肢に○を付けてください。

正解は最終ページにあります。すべて解いてから確認してください。

ReadPassで復習

大問1 語彙・文法 Q1-Q4

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(1) Walter's soccer team lost the game because they did not play (1) enough. If they had worried less about defense and had tried to score more goals, they probably would have won.

1 needlessly 2 aggressively 3 cautiously 4 helplessly

(2) Tom is very bright for his age. He is able to do math problems of some (2) although his classmates are still learning the basics.

1 appliance 2 generosity 3 clearance 4 complexity

(3) Annual floods along the Nile River make the soil there extremely (3). This made it possible for an agricultural civilization to develop there around 5,000 years ago.

1 devout 2 wretched 3 earnest 4 fertile

(4) The children could not (4) opening their presents on Christmas morning. They got up early and began opening them before their parents had awoken.

1 resist 2 dispute 3 flourish 4 drain

大問1 語彙・文法 Q5-Q9

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(5) A man was arrested at the airport yesterday for attempting to (5) illegal drugs into the country.

- 1 erupt 2 smuggle 3 reign 4 infest

(6) Soon after they met, the young couple became (6). They spent all of their free time together.

- 1 implicit 2 inedible 3 immature 4 inseparable

(7) Although the medicine did not completely relieve Frank's headache, it made the pain more (7), and he was able to continue working.

- 1 tolerable 2 slippery 3 militant 4 abrupt

(8) The man was in (8) that his marriage was over. Even after his wife left and filed for divorce, he insisted it was possible to get back together.

- 1 denial 2 contradiction 3 majesty 4 prejudice

(9) The walls inside the city hall building are decorated with (9) painted by famous artists. The huge paintings never fail to impress visitors.

- 1 memoirs 2 margins 3 monarchies 4 murals

大問1 語彙・文法 Q10-Q14

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

- (10) The Ferris wheel began to (10) slowly, lifting the carriages and their passengers high above the city and then down again.
1 revolve 2 digest 3 compile 4 afflict
- (11) Yesterday, a (11) broke out in the state prison. According to reports, the prisoners reacted violently in protest to overcrowding and poor food quality.
1 flurry 2 cascade 3 swirl 4 riot
- (12) Brad drove so carelessly that it was (12) he would have an accident. And last week, that exact situation occurred.
1 crucial 2 debatable 3 inevitable 4 sacrificial
- (13) Although her son claims he broke the vase by accident, Anika thinks he did it (13) because he was angry at her for making him clean his room.
1 loyally 2 deliberately 3 spatially 4 expansively
- (14) Many residents wanted to (14) the town hall as a historic building since it was over one hundred years old.
1 designate 2 assemble 3 undertake 4 compromise

大問1 語彙・文法 Q15-Q18

次の(1)から(18)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを1, 2, 3, 4の中から一つ選びなさい。

(15) As soon as they heard police sirens, the thieves (15) into the woods to avoid being caught.

- 1 took off 2 missed out 3 wore out 4 passed over

(16) The Nelsons tried to sell their house earlier this year, but few people were interested in buying it. They have decided to (16) until the market improves.

- 1 turn over 2 ring in 3 hold off 4 rain down

(17) At the start of every meeting, the team leader quickly (17) a list of topics that will be discussed so that everyone knows what to expect.

- 1 plays out 2 smooths over 3 runs through 4 clears out

(18) Neither side was willing to (18) during the trade negotiations, so the two countries could not reach an agreement.

- 1 catch on 2 throw off 3 fix up 4 back down

大問2A 長文の語句空所補充 Q19-Q21

次の英文A, Bを読み, その文意にそって(19)から(24)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

Doppelgänger

In German mythology, doppelgänger were spirits that took on the exact form of the people they revealed themselves to. The term doppelgänger was first used by a German author in the 1800s, but similar spirit doubles can be found in old traditional stories from countries across Europe and parts of Africa. (19), they appeared thousands of years ago in ancient Greek and ancient Egyptian myths. In most cases, these spirits were feared, as it was believed that encountering them was a sign that death would come soon.

Today, the word doppelgänger is generally used simply to refer to two people who look extremely similar to each other. According to one researcher in the United States, people (20). He explains that this is because humans only have a limited number of genes that control facial features. Since there are now billions of people in the world, there is a significant chance that certain genes have been combined in very similar ways more than once.

The similarity between modern-day doppelgänger goes beyond their facial features. One study that analyzed pairs of doppelgänger showed there was a higher-than-average chance of them sharing common lifestyle traits, such as their educational levels and smoking habits. This discovery (21). It is known that people with similar DNA are more likely to develop the same genetic diseases. This implies that facial features could be used to identify people at risk of developing such diseases so that they can take preventative measures.

- (19)

1 As a result

2 Even so

3 In fact

4 On the other hand
- (20)

1 are still afraid of meeting their doubles

2 are more likely to have doubles than they think

3 have lost interest in the subject

4 have a poor understanding of genetics
- (21)

1 may be misleading

2 was rejected by other researchers

3 was difficult to explain

4 may have a practical use

大問2B 長文の語句空所補充 Q22-Q24

次の英文A, Bを読み, その文意にそって(19)から(24)までの()に入れるのに最も適切なものを選びなさい。

Roman Concrete

The ancient Romans were known as talented architects and builders who built amphitheaters, temples, bridges, and reservoirs. (22), and the reason why has fascinated researchers. The structures' durability has generally been attributed to the unique mix of volcanic ash and another material called lime in the concrete used to help build them. However, analysis of the concrete revealed it contained chunks of lime, which indicated the concrete may not have been mixed as well as it should have been. This was puzzling as the Romans had a reputation for high-quality work and craftsmanship.

A team of researchers recently dug deeper. One of the researchers suspected the chunks (23). Analysis using the latest scanning techniques showed that the lime chunks likely resulted from a special high-temperature process called hot mixing. This convinced the researchers that the chunks were not the result of a mixing error. Hot mixing gives concrete chemical properties that make it stronger than regular concrete. Moreover, it is quicker to set, which enables structures to be built more quickly.

The remarkable qualities of Roman concrete do not end there. The researchers found that it also has self-healing properties. When cracks form in regular concrete, they often spread. In Roman concrete, however, when water enters a crack, the lime chunks react with the water to crystallize as calcium carbonate. (24), this fills the crack and prevents it from spreading. This may help explain why Roman structures have remained intact for so long despite being exposed to water.

(22)

- 1 Most materials were imported
- 2 Some were incorrectly classified
- 3 Many survive to this day
- 4 The designs are rarely similar

(23)

- 1 had been damaged by other scientists
- 2 caused structural problems
- 3 were intentionally created
- 4 would remain a mystery

(24)

- 1 Likewise
- 2 Consequently
- 3 Nonetheless
- 4 On the contrary

大問3A 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ25-Q27に答えなさい。

From Spongy Moths to Astronomy

Étienne Léopold Trouvelot was a French illustrator who emigrated to the United States in the mid-1800s. While he made a living from his drawings, he was also an amateur entomologist. He had an interest in insects, and he raised silk moths on his property in the state of Massachusetts. The caterpillars of these moths, or silkworms, were to thank for a successful silk industry in Europe, but they were also vulnerable to diseases. Trouvelot wanted to create a better-protected variety, so he set about trying to crossbreed his silk moths with spongy moths obtained from Europe. He chose spongy moths because their caterpillars were covered in hairs, which deterred birds and other animals from eating them. They also fed mainly on the leaves of oak trees, which were common where Trouvelot lived. Unfortunately, some of these spongy moths escaped and, because they had no natural predators, multiplied rapidly in the wild. Over the next few decades, spongy moth populations grew out of control, and their caterpillars were responsible for stripping many trees of their leaves in nearby forests. Since then, spongy moths have spread across large areas of the northeastern United States, and they remain a problematic invasive species.

The spongy moth incident marked the end of Trouvelot's hopes of becoming a respected entomologist, but a rare natural phenomenon led him to a different field of study. Not long after his moths escaped, a solar storm caused an aurora to be visible in Massachusetts, and Trouvelot was inspired to make illustrations of the lights that appeared in the night sky. These illustrations turned out to be so good that Trouvelot was invited to work at a well-known US observatory. There, he began making detailed and beautiful astronomical drawings by painstakingly recording the images he saw through telescopes.

Trouvelot's drawings allowed people to visualize planets and moons in a way that had not been possible before. Today, Trouvelot's work is widely recognized as being responsible for increasing public interest in astronomy, a field that had previously been out of reach to most people. Modern astrophotography technology, which allows astronomers to take high-quality photographs with telescopes, has also revealed the astounding accuracy of Trouvelot's drawings. His illustrations closely match recent photographs despite the fact that they were created using regular art materials. Ironically, it was the same astrophotography that made his drawings unnecessary. This did not prevent them from being appreciated, however - they are now exhibited in museums for people to enjoy.

大問3A 長文設問 Q25-Q27

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

(25)

According to the first paragraph, Étienne Léopold Trouvelot

- 1 hoped to grow the silk industry in Europe by taking moths there that he collected in the United States.
- 2 bred a new variety of moth that helped to save the silk industry by increasing the amount of silk that could be produced.
- 3 accidentally introduced a species of moth to the United States that caused widespread environmental damage.
- 4 found a way to protect spongy moths from a fatal disease that had greatly reduced their numbers in Europe.

(26)

What is implied about Trouvelot in the second paragraph?

- 1 He always regretted turning down an offer to work in a famous observatory.
- 2 He ended up pursuing a career in astronomy as the result of an unexpected event.
- 3 He succeeded in fulfilling his childhood dream of doing research related to the night sky.
- 4 He only decided to study astronomy because doing so allowed him to stay in the United States.

(27)

What does the author of the passage describe as ironic?

- 1 Trouvelot's work would likely have been less accurate if he had been able to use the materials that are available today.
- 2 Trouvelot never became well-known during his lifetime because most people had little interest in astronomy.
- 3 The scientific value of Trouvelot's drawings prevents them from being put on public display for people to enjoy.
- 4 The technology that proved the high quality of Trouvelot's illustrations was also responsible for them becoming unnecessary.

大問3B 長文

本文を読み、次ページのQ28-Q31に答えなさい。

Bretton Woods

In 1944, at Bretton Woods in the US state of New Hampshire, a conference of Allied countries was convened to create a stable international monetary and financial order. The period since World War I had been one of turmoil that witnessed protectionist trade policies, hyperinflation, the Great Depression, and, ultimately, World War II. Such events weighed on delegates' shoulders but also underpinned their belief that reform was urgent. Although World War II continued to rage, the pendulum was swinging strongly in the Allies' favor. Nevertheless, delegates had concerns. As one US delegate put it, "We fight together on sodden battlefields. . . . The test of this conference is whether we can walk together, solve our economic problems, down the road to peace as we today march to victory."

The conference delegates included Harry Dexter White of the US Treasury and John Maynard Keynes, a well-known British economist. The United States had become the world's most powerful economy, overtaking the colonial European powers, and the agreement that emerged reinforced its dominant position. The Bretton Woods system hinged on an arrangement that directly linked the value of the US dollar to gold. At the time, the US Federal Reserve possessed the world's largest reserves of gold, so as White pointed out, it seemed unlikely the United States would run out. The knowledge that the US dollar was backed by gold helped establish it as the world's primary reserve currency, and the other signees agreed to tie the value of their currencies to the US dollar.

Initially, the dollar's stability brought some success. However, cracks began to appear. The leading European powers, for example, whose productive capabilities had been severely damaged in the war, were heavily dependent on US imports. These had to be paid for in US dollars, but some countries had insufficient dollar funds to do this. As George C. Marshall, the US secretary of state, said at the time, Europe's requirements for food imports and essential products "are so much greater than her present ability to pay that she must have substantial additional help or face economic, social, and political deterioration of a very grave character." Concerns were raised that Europe might return to protectionist trade policies, which might negatively affect the free-trade-supporting United States. To address these and other concerns, the Marshall Plan was approved to provide billions of dollars in aid.

Despite such efforts, further economic challenges occurred. Germany and France effectively left the Bretton Woods system, inflation increased in many countries, and the United States saw increased domestic and military spending. Such factors affected the valuation of, and confidence in, the dollar. In 1971, the United States suspended the dollar's convertibility to gold, effectively ending the Bretton Woods system. Nevertheless, its legacy lives on in the shape of the International Monetary Fund (IMF) and the World Bank, which emerged out of the system. The IMF's role as an organization that monitors and supports global monetary cooperation and the World Bank's loans and grants to governments in need form a core element of the modern financial order.

大問3B 長文設問 Q28-Q31

前ページの本文を読み、最も適切なものを1つ選びなさい。

- (28) What was the concern of the US delegate mentioned in the first paragraph?
- 1 It was important for delegates to admit that some fundamental problems with the interwar financial order would never be solved.
 - 2 European nations did not understand the need for reform, as they had not been affected by the Great Depression as much as the United States had.
 - 3 Holding the conference in 1944 might have been a mistake, as it was not clear that the Allies would win World War II.
 - 4 Although the Allies were working together to win the war, there were doubts about whether such cooperation would continue in economic fields.
- (29) What was one reason put forth by Harry Dexter White to justify the structure of the Bretton Woods agreement?
- 1 The United States was the only nation in a position to ensure that its currency would be stable enough to be used as a reserve currency.
 - 2 It was important to allow Great Britain to feel it was still equal in terms of political power to the United States despite the dominance of the US dollar.
 - 3 Both he and John Maynard Keynes felt European powers needed to hold onto their colonies to help them boost their productive capabilities.
 - 4 Other countries would be able to use their large reserves of gold to support the value of their own currencies in the international financial system.
- (30) According to the author of the passage, after problems with the Bretton Woods system began to appear,
- 1 the European powers decided to try to raise capital by forcing other countries to pay for European food products in US dollars.
 - 2 the British and American delegations did their best to ensure that George C. Marshall's comments about European decline were not made public.
 - 3 the United States proposed protectionist trade policies as it had become clear that European countries were taking advantage of its leniency.
 - 4 the United States took action to assist European countries partly because doing so would also benefit the United States.
- (31) What can be concluded about the Bretton Woods system?
- 1 The system may have been more successful if the IMF had insisted that the US dollar remained tied to gold.
 - 2 Although the system itself ended in failure, some economic organizations that play an important role today owe their existence to it.
 - 3 The United States should have ended the system earlier to prevent a loss of confidence in the US dollar as a global currency.
 - 4 Although both the IMF and the World Bank are influential today, their actions were considered the main reason for the system's downfall.

正解一覧

すべて解き終えてから確認してください。 大問3は正解番号のみを表示しています。



Q01-Q11	Q12-Q21	Q22-Q31
Q012 aggressively 2	Q123 inevitable 3	Q223 Many survive to this day 3
Q024 complexity 4	Q135 deliberately 2	Q236 were intentionally created 3
Q036 fertile 4	Q147 designate 1	Q248 Consequently 2
Q048 resist 1	Q159 took off 1	Q259 3
Q059 smuggle 2	Q169 hold off 3	Q269 2
Q069 inseparable 4	Q179 runs through 3	Q279 4
Q079 tolerable 1	Q189 back down 4	Q289 4
Q089 denial 1	Q199 In fact 3	Q299 1
Q099 murals 4	Q209 are more likely to have doubles than they think 2	Q309 4
Q109 revolve 1	Q219 may have a practical use 4	Q319 2
Q119 riot 4		

学習記録

得点

/ 31

やり直す問題

メモ